

Site B, Student Interview 3

[0:00:00.0]

Interviewer: Okey-dokey. So our first question today is, how did the lessons or discussions around data analysis go for you in [Site B Instructor] class? What were some of your experiences like if anything comes to mind?

Sammy: I think [Site B Instructor] was a great instructor and I think she did a great job with her lessons as well.

Interviewer: [0:00:30.0] And then when you think about like data analysis, some of the lectures around data analysis, do any words or theories or anything like that come to mind?

Sammy: I would think that themes would be one word that I would think of in data analysis. And I know [Site B Instructor] did a really good job of explaining themes and making sure we understood those. And [0:01:00.0] had us go through, I remember a written paper that we went through and picked out themes and charted them in one of the classes.

Interviewer: Can you tell me a little bit, do you remember how did [Site B Instructor] talk about themes with you all?

Sammy: I might still have the paper. I don't. That was I believe the last class period and there [0:01:30.0] were themes and sub-themes, and I know she named a few themes that we were supposed to go through and pick out of the reading that she provided to us as well.

Interviewer: So then thinking also back to your lessons and discussions around data analysis, so like those lectures around themes. Do you think- Do you recall any approach to qualitative data analysis that [0:02:00.0] you learned?

Sammy: What do you mean by approach?

Interviewer: Like they're- like when. When I say approach, I mean like a particular methodology or like a lens that you tried to make sense of analysis through?

Sammy: I see. I do remember her talking about lenses, looking through a particular type of lens. And I am not going to use the proper [0:02:30.0] terminology right now because I don't

have it in front of me. But I, when I interviewed, because we had to interview someone for a qualitative study within her classroom. When I did the interpretation of that data, analyzing that data, I was like an outsider looking in rather than an insider talking to another insider about a particular subject. If that makes sense.

[0:03:00.0] **Interviewer:** Yeah, that totally makes sense and you're using the right language, in my opinion so

Sammy: Okay.

Interviewer: Okey-dokey. What did you find particularly helpful in the lessons and discussions around analyzing your data.

Sammy: Um [Site B Instructor] used a book by Deon Dans called “Crossing segregated boundaries”. And it was about Chicago school desegregation. And that book, Dr. Dan's put several interviews [0:03:30.0] of foreign Chicago school students within that book. And I think this book was the biggest help for me in understanding how I should be interpreting data and how I should be you know writing [inaudible] so to speak after listening to someone speak about their own personal experience. So that was very helpful. And then [Site B Instructor] played a video for us in, and I [0:04:00.0] can't remember who the video pertained too, but she was a professor, I believe, out of New York City and she was dying of cancer. The video was going through her life and documenting her life about exploring the Jewish community. That was really helpful as well.

Interviewer: What do you think was particularly helpful about that video?

Sammy: It was someone's personal [0:04:30.0] lived experience, I think.

Interviewer: And do you think that actually that help do you that like understand qualitative data analysis was through engaging with that material of personal lived experiences, like you said?

Sammy: Yes. Because I come from a scientific background. I worked in the science industry for a very long time. So I have a large amount of quantitative experience and that [0:05:00.0] data is very hard and fast, black and white. And when I considered qualitative as compared to quantitative, I think qualitative uses a lot more soft skills. And follow up thought, to quantitative. So I think that, you know, both reading the book and seeing that the video, allowed me to understand qualitative reasoning a lot better than if I had not been exposed to [0:05:30.0] those materials.

Interviewer: And then thinking about your lessons and discussions about analyzing your data, did you find anything confusing or unclear about qualitative data analysis?

Sammy: Uh no, [Site B Instructor] always explained it very well, I think.

Interviewer: And so, we notice that [Site B Instructor] went ahead – and you might have already brought this up – but she provided you with a segment of interview [0:06:00.0] data, and then invited you to code and memo that data, and it was titled “[daughter] and her dad.” Do you remember this exercise?

Sammy: I do.

Interviewer: What did you think about that activity?

Sammy: I thought it was good.

Interviewer: What specifically about that activity did you think went well for you?

Sammy: Well, it was my first experience coding. But again, just [0:06:30.0] being exposed to someone's personal lived experiences and being able to read an interview done like that was helpful in my own work. Kind of like an example of, of what to follow, I suppose.

Interviewer: So, I mentioned that, or you mentioned the word coding. What do you mean by coding? Can you talk to me a little bit about what coding means [0:07:00.0] to you?

Sammy: I guess I would really like find that as sub-type under themes, if that makes sense.

Interviewer: Totally. Do you remember at all how [Site B Instructor] talked to you all about coding? And I know this is going back some time, so it's okay if if it's an I don't know because I probably wouldn't forgot.

Sammy: I [0:07:30.0] do remember the exact project that you mentioned, the [daughter] thing, But I don't remember the exact words that [Site B Instructor] used in describing it.

Interviewer: No problem. And then you also already mentioned, you already mentioned this film, but [Site B Instructor] went ahead and she invited you all to watch a film. And you already told me a little bit about that. But can you [0:08:00.0] tell me what kinds of things did you, did [Site B Instructor] ask you to take note of when you were watching that film?

Sammy: Again, I'm not sure that I remember exact comments that she did on the film. I do remember the film itself because it was really interesting to me. But I don't remember any exact comments that that [Site B Instructor] made.

[INTERVIEWER]: Do you recall anything that you remember taking note of are being particularly drawn into?

Interviewer: I think some of the experiences on the film were maybe interesting to me. Like when, again, I can't remember the lady's name in the film, but she was trying on a wig because she thought she thought she was going to lose her hair from cancer. When [0:09:00.0] she went to the pool in the Jewish community. And again, that's not the proper term for the swimming pool, but basically she went to cleanse herself in the swimming pool. Those were all scenarios that I would not have been familiar with had I not seen the movie.

Interviewer: How did you view this activity, this viewing of the movie as connected to [0:09:30.0] learning about analyzing qualitative data.

Sammy: Um honestly, I wouldn't consider it as teaching me how to analyze qualitative data, but I thought it was good exposure to a qualitative study in the documentary portion of it.

Interviewer: And when you say exposure to a qualitative study, do you think that is specifically linked to viewing that film, like seeing it in engaging with [0:10:00.0] it?

Sammy: Yes, I think it is exposing someone to someone else's personal life and what they're experiencing at that moment in time.

Interviewer: Okay, So this is probably my favorite question of the interview protocol here. What suggestions might you have for how an instructor might teach qualitative data analysis differently to better support your learning?

Sammy: Um gosh, I don't [0:10:30.0] know. I've taken two qualitative courses right now and both professors did an excellent job. I think the first instructor I had was very, very structured.

And I think [Site B Instructor] was less structured, but I still learned good deal from her. And more so of the soft skills, the interviewing skills, how to categorize things, how to identify themes. That type of thing. Whereas, [0:11:00.0] I'm not sure I learned that in the first course, but um, it was still very structured and very applicable. Um, I don't know, I don't have any concerns for either class I guess.

Interviewer: No that's great. You used the word categorized and themes kind of next to each other, and I'm wondering if you see categorizing and theming [0:11:30.0] data differently? And if so, how do you make sense of those distinctions?

Sammy: Um.. (pause)

Interviewer: And if you don't, if they're just the same thing to you, that's also okay. So there's really no right or wrong answers here.

Sammy: I guess that's how I see qualitative research as well, is that it really is someone's [0:12:00.0] interpretation of someone else's experience. So I guess that's open to interpretation. Just how I would explain it.

Interviewer: And then if you were going to talk another qualitative research class in that class was going to be specifically about, you know, looking at an interview or looking at a movie and then analyzing that. For example, do you have any suggestions or [0:12:30.0] anything that you think would be really helpful for an instructor to maybe lead or bring up or anything that might guide your learning process better as you learned about the analysis process?

Sammy: Um I don't know. I don't know.

Interviewer: That's okay. I don't know is a perfectly acceptable answer.

Sammy: Okay.

Interviewer: And then finally, is there anything [0:13:00.0] else that you would like to share with me today about qualitative data analysis and your experiences learning about it?

Sammy: No, I just I found it really interesting and it's, had I not taken [Site B Instructor] course, I don't think I would've been exposed to some of the things when I was. So I'm grateful for that.

Interviewer: Wonderful. Well, [0:13:30.0] this brings us to the end of our protocol and it looks like we're just at time. So, I want to make sure that I'm respecting that. Do you have any questions for me before we go ahead and hop off here?

Sammy: No, I don't.

Interviewer: Okedoke. Well, you can expect a follow-up e-mail for me just thanking you and again, [0:14:00.0] it's really, really appreciated. Thank you for your time so much, and I hope you have a good rest of your week and a good summer.

Sammy: All right. You too. Thank you.

Interviewer: Of course. Buh-bye. Bye.